# Factsheet: John Pritchard Williamson (1922–2014)

*Numbers in brackets refer to the Sources list in biography.md.*

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| **Name** | John Pritchard Williamson (also John P. Williamson) |
| **Born** | Feb. 22, 1922, Cleveland, Ohio [2][6][7][8] |
| **Died** | Oct. 26, 2014, Parkcliffe Community, Northwood, near Toledo, Ohio; age 92 [1][2][9] |
| **Parents** | John and Jane (Pritchard) Williamson [2][6][10] |
| **Spouse** | Helen (Morgan) Williamson; married Aug. 3, 1945; she died Aug. 5, 2019 [5][10][36] |
| **Children** | Three sons [2][5] |
| **Education** | Kent State University, business administration degree, 1945 [5][12]; business manager of the Kent Stater (1944; again 1945) [30][13]; associate editor, Chestnut Burr [31][29]; Blue Key and Men's Union president [13] |
| **Profession** | Certified public accountant; Arthur Andersen & Company [2][11][6]; The Toledo Edison Company, 1951–1987 [5][11] |
| **Toledo Edison career** | 1951 Director of Systems and Procedures [2][11][10]; 1962 secretary and treasurer [2][15]; c. 1965 vice president of finance [2][16][10]; 1968 senior vice president [2][10][7]; 1972 president and CEO (youngest since 1921) [1][19][20][21][17]; 1979 chairman and CEO [2][10][18]; 1987 chairman emeritus of Toledo Edison and Centerior Energy [1][5] |
| **Notable projects** | Davis-Besse Nuclear Power Station (at the helm through its 1977 startup) [1][22]; proposed the 1985 affiliation with Cleveland Electric Illuminating that created Centerior Energy [4][23][25] |
| **Industry roles** | Chairman, East Central Area Reliability Council [26][10]; president, Ohio Electric Utility Institute [10]; Edison Electric Institute executive committee; chairman, National Electric Security Committee [10]; chairman, North American Electric Reliability Council (3-year term from 1984) [10][27]; all per his obituary [2] |
| **Civic leadership** | Chairman, Greater Toledo Area United Way (1971); president, Toledo Community Chest (1972) [10] [6]; past president, Toledo Kiwanis Club and Toledo Area Chamber of Commerce; past chairman, Ohio Chamber of Commerce [2]; first chairman, Toledo Development Committee [2][6]; Toledo Symphony trustee for nearly three decades, served as chairman [3]; boards include Toledo Museum of Art [28], Riverside Hospital, Toledo Hospital, Toledo Trust, First National Bank of Toledo [24], Red Cross, Junior Achievement, Boys Club [2]; Salvation Army board; a City of Toledo board; Ohio Development Advisory Council (1977) |
| **Honors** | Kent State Distinguished Alumnus Award, 1974 [12][5][2]; Toledo Area Citizen of the Year [2][14]; Kent State University medallion, 1992 [14]; Kentucky Colonel |
| **Kent State legacy** | First life members of the Alumni Association (1975); lead gift for the Williamson Alumni Center (former Curtiss House, the president's home), dedicated Oct. 10, 1992 [33][35][5] |
| **Retirement** | Homes in Rio Verde, Arizona, and Perrysburg, Ohio; horseback riding; world travel; Stephen Minister at Rio Verde Community Church (1996) |
| **Survivors named in obituary** | Wife Helen (d. 2019); three sons; a grandson and a great-grandson; other family members [2] |

**Photos:** main portrait, The Blade (Toledo Blade); couple photo, Photo by Bob Christy '95, Kent State University Alumni Association.

**Sources used:** [1] The Blade, news story, Oct. 28, 2014; [2] Legacy.com / The Blade family obituary, Oct. 28, 2014; [3] Toledo Community Foundation, Williamson's Donor Story; [4] The New York Times, June 27, 1985; [5] Kent State Magazine, Alumni Life tribute (Mar. 22, 2020); [6] Who's Who in Finance and Industry, 1975–76; [7] World Who's Who in Finance and Industry, 1969; [8] Find a Grave memorial 224691877; [9] Univ. of Toledo Alumni eMagazine, Jan. 29, 2015; [10] Who's Who in the Midwest, 1996–97; [11] Edison Electric Institute Bulletin, Nov. 1958; [12] Kent State, Past Alumni Award Recipients; [13] Chestnut Burr 1945; [14] Who's Who in America, 1992–93; [15] Who's Who in America, 1982–83; [16] Michigan State Univ., Institute of Public Utilities brochure (c. 1965–66); [17] Univ. of Toledo Canaday Center, John Davis Papers (MSS-338) finding aid; [18] Toledo Edison, Bay Shore Recognition Day (PRSA Silver Anvil entry, c. 1980); [19] U.S. NRC, Davis-Besse operating-license application amendment, Dec. 8, 1972 (ML19329B578); [20] U.S. NRC, Davis-Besse operating-license application, rev. Dec. 16, 1976 (ML20008D686); [21] Federal Register, Mar. 12, 1974, p. 9581 (FPC notice, Docket ID-1724); [22] World Nuclear Association, Davis Besse 1 reactor database entry; [23] U.S. NRC, Perry docket letter enclosing CEI press release, June 25, 1985 (ML20128R117); [24] Who's Who in the Midwest, 1988–89 and 2013; [25] UPI, Apr. 18, 1986; [26] NERC Annual Report 1981; [27] Prabook profile; [28] Toledo Museum of Art, Annual Report 1989–90; [29] Chestnut Burr 1944; [30] Kent Stater, Jan. 26, 1945; [31] Kent Stater, Dec. 12, 1944; [32] Kent State, Alumni Award Categories; [33] Kent State Alumni Association, Williamson Alumni Center History; [34] Kent State Alumni, Mission and History timeline; [35] Kent State Libraries, Cartwright papers finding aid; [36] Helen Williamson obituary, The Blade/Legacy.com, Aug. 2019